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Hold Your AI to the Same Standard as Your People

The AI-vs-agent checklist: 7 disciplines, the KPIs to track, and COPC's four governance questions.

For every discipline you apply to a new hire, ask whether your AI gets the same. Score each row: 2 = in place and evidenced, 1 = partly, 0 = missing. An empty box on the right is your gap.

Discipline	Your human agents	Your AI agent	0–2
Hiring and onboarding	Define the role, train, certify before going live.	Define which intents AI owns and never owns; test against real cases; approve go-live.	☐
Quality assurance	Score a sample of interactions against a rubric.	Score AI conversations with the same rubric, not a separate one, every week.	☐
Core metrics	Resolution, repeat contact, CSAT.	Resolution after AI-first journeys, repeat contact within a short window, CSAT on AI interactions.	☐
Coaching	Feedback loops and calibration sessions.	Review failed conversations, update knowledge and instructions, re-test.	☐
Escalation	Clear rules for when to transfer.	Measure successful AI-to-human handoffs, with full context passed. Check that every promised handoff actually happens.	☐
Supervision	Supervisors review edge cases.	People review high-risk and low-certainty AI decisions.	☐
Governance	Policies, compliance, audits.	Log, test and audit what AI may do on its own and what needs human review.	☐
		Total (out of 14)	☐

Containment is not resolution. A customer who gave up is "contained" too. COPC's CX Standard R8.0 calls containment Autonomous Handle Rate and lists it next to resolution and FCR, never instead of them. Pick 3–5 outcome metrics before launch and pair them with risk indicators.

KPI translation: same outcome, different instrument

For agents	For AI
Contact resolution / FCR	Resolution after AI-first journeys (not containment)
Repeat contact	Customers who come back within a short window (e.g. 7 days) after an AI conversation
CSAT	CSAT on AI interactions, reported separately and combined
Transfer rate	Successful handoff rate, with context, and promised handoffs completed
Complaints	Complaint trend linked to AI journeys (a risk indicator)

COPC's four questions to answer before (and after) go-live

1. Where may the AI act on its own, and where must it stop?
2. What gets logged, and who reviews it, how often?
3. How do customers know they are talking to AI?
4. How fast can a customer reach a person?

> **Edition 28 lesson: an AI agent nobody reaches is a cost with no data. Before scoring the bot, confirm real customers are reaching it.**

Sources: COPC CX Standard for Customer Operations, Release 8.0 (COPC Inc., 2026); J. Tropeano, AI in CX, 2026 (COPC executive guide). Checklist adapted by Juan Carlos Munguia from CX Hub Excellence Insights, editions 27–28.